

INDUSTRY TALK

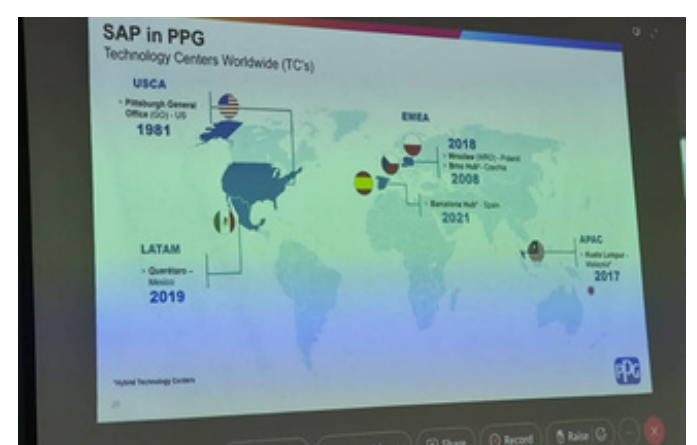
5th November 2025

Summary of Talk

Industry Talk: Enterprise System and Design Modelling (5 Nov 2025) Students of the Enterprise System and Design Modelling (SECP3744) course attendees were treated to a talk by Patrick Thong of SAP CoE Operations who gave a practical overview of the world's business systems.

The event focused on PPG, a Fortune 500 paint and coating company, which served as a case study within the ERP industry. Mr. Thong described the way PPG uses individual SAP modules—SD for the company's "Order to Cash" (OTC) cycle, MM for "Procure to Pay" (PTP)—in order to be effective on a world-wide level

The class showcased internships and job positions available in PPG Malaysia's Digital IT center.

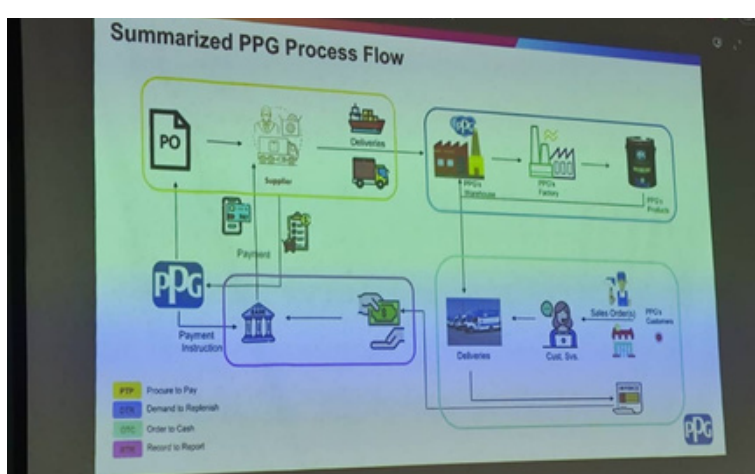


Technology and Issues Discussed

SAP ERP systems cover all sections and levels of an organization from finance, sales, material management, and production. This is where a lot of the conversation around these systems centers.

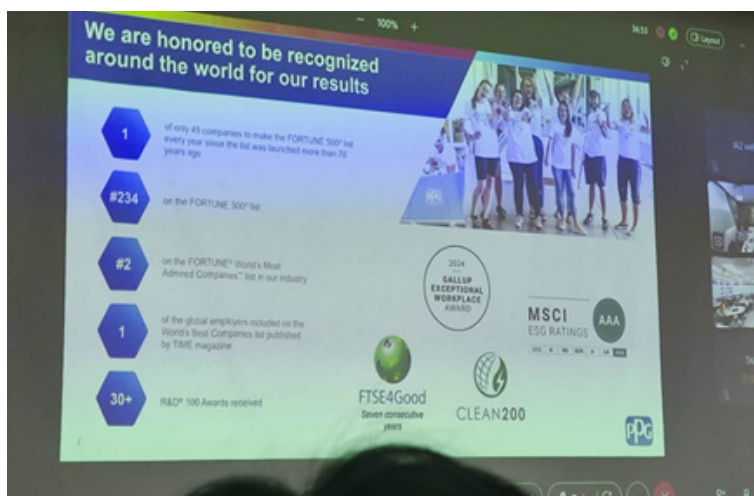
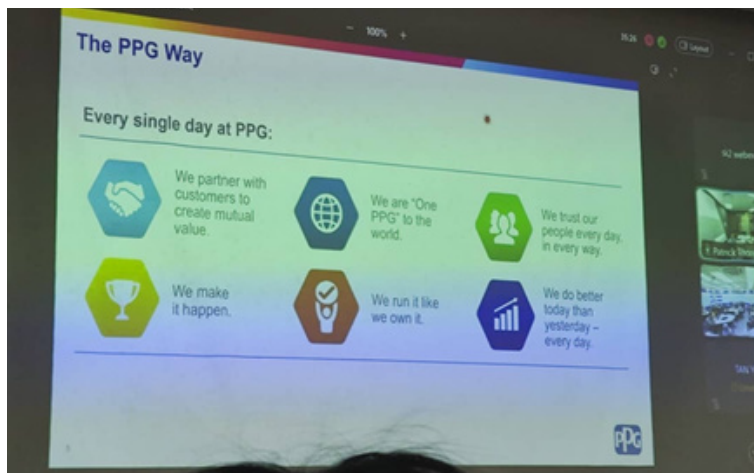
The discussions also included PPG's journey with implementing SAP — from R/1 in 1991 to S/4HANA Cloud, 2025 which integrates real-time analytics and improved automation for global productivity and decision-making. PPG digital initiatives also included SAP SAC and Cloud (BW) for data governance, RPA & CoE for Data Analytics, cloud integration for security and scale.

About presentation, integration with other systems, data consistency, and training of end-users were underlined as the main challenges of an ERP in such a size.



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Reflection (Goh Jiale)

In conclusion, the key takeaway I learned during the talk is that the most impactful technologies are often unseen. We see PPG's paint, but the real innovation is the "SAP system" that makes the former possible. This system produces a "truth" for the the entire company, functioning as the "plumbing" of our global supply chain to ensure that the right products are required for success. As a student, I found this talk inspiring because it proves that knowledge of these basic foundation systems that power the world's businesses are capable of offering excellent career prospects.

Reflection (Ling Yu Qian)

The SAP is virtues to transform business and change my processes, and optimize the operation. They not only reduce manual improve the quality of decisions, but bring finance, manufacturing, and the supply chain into the room. This PPG SAP S/4HANA Cloud scenario, where automation and analysis enable the optimization of operational efficiency, improve teamwork, and contribute towards fighting climate change. This excites me to be able to use technology for good that liberates the workers to put more of their hearts and souls into those aspects of sustainable development that appeal to us.

